Quietly

Module 1: Foundational — Marketing 101

Marketing Disciplines: An Overview

Module 1: Chapters

01 **Marketing Disciplines - An Overview**

Understanding various marketing functions, and how they all fit together.

02 **The Connective Tissue**

How content strategy acts as the "dark matter" or connective tissue between disparate marketing departments.

03 **B2B & Stakeholder Archetypes**

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04 **How Other Agencies Do It**

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In this chapter...



Overview

This module positions content as the "connective tissue" across marketing functions and the broader organization, including HR Sales and beyond. It highlights how content alignment acts as a force multiplier and establishes the need for an "Enterprise content strategy" to ensure a consistent, unified brand narrative across all departments and audiences.

Time required to complete this chapter: 15 to 20 mins

Outcomes

What you should know coming out of it:

- Understand how and why content extends beyond Marketing
- Define "Enterprise content strategy"
- Explain how content joins up all of an organization's departments, LoBs and channels

To consider as you step through this chapter...

- What does ‘content’ mean and/or how does it come to life across different teams, LoBs and functions across an organization?
- In what ways is the role of content expanding beyond traditional Marketing and Communications to influence broader organizational functions?
- How does content strategy serve as the "connective tissue" or "dark matter" that bridges gaps between disparate marketing disciplines?

Heads up

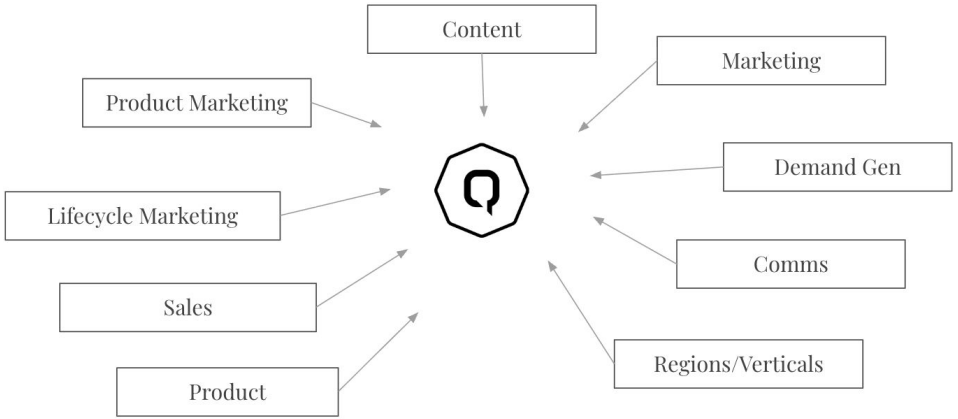
You will be taking a 5 minute multiple choice quiz at the end of this chapter. Be sure to take notes as you progress.

Now, let's get into it...

The content landscape

Content can mean anything and everything—Paid Media, Digital Marketing, Product Marketing Demand Generation, GTM Channel/Partner Marketing, Sales/Field Marketing, Social Media/Community Management.

But now, content is playing an increasingly important role outside of Marketing & Communications.

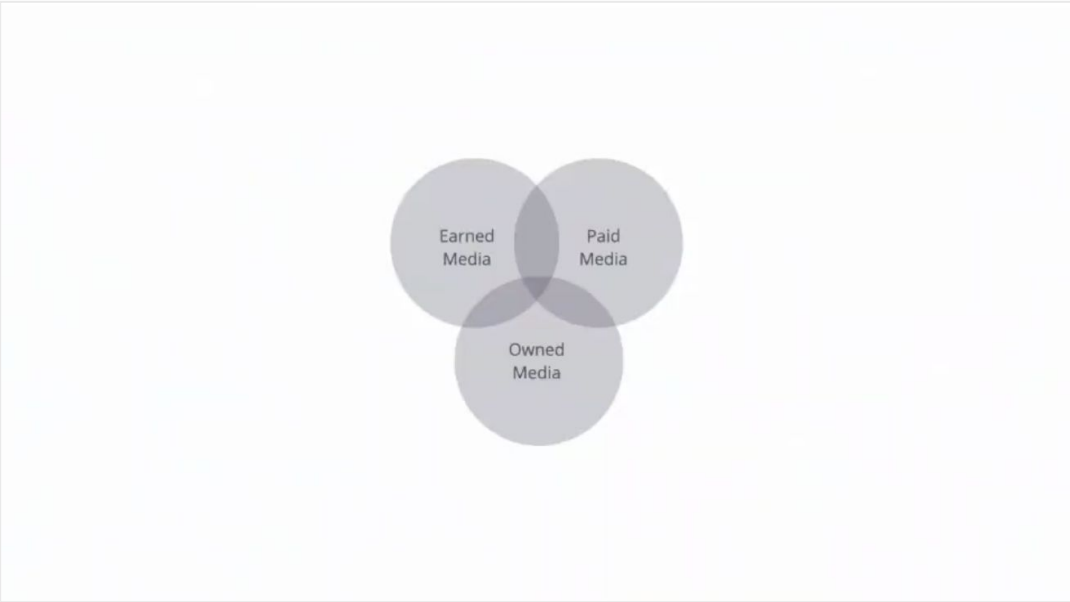


Content acts as a force multiplier

Content becomes more effective when it is working in alignment between channels, teams, journeys, etc.

The state of converged media means content is impacting all content types and delivery channels:

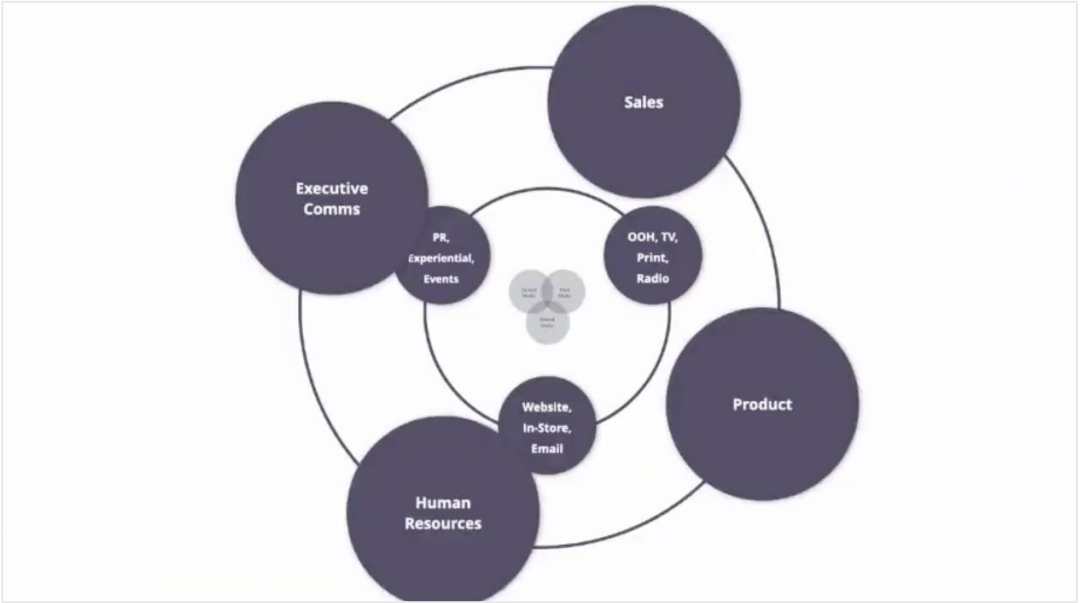
- Good web/blog content increases organic search traffic
- Good organic content improves paid social
- Sponsored content/articles outperforms display advertising



Content outside of Marketing

Content also exists across departments, functions and lines of business as well as outside of the organization

- Executive comms: Content is building credibility outside the boardroom
- HR: Content is supporting recruitment and retention
- Sales: Content is driving sales enablement (front line staff)
- Product: Content is supporting core product needs (e.g. features and functionality positioning)
- Channel partners: Content also is an active agent for partners who work to deliver adjacent offerings

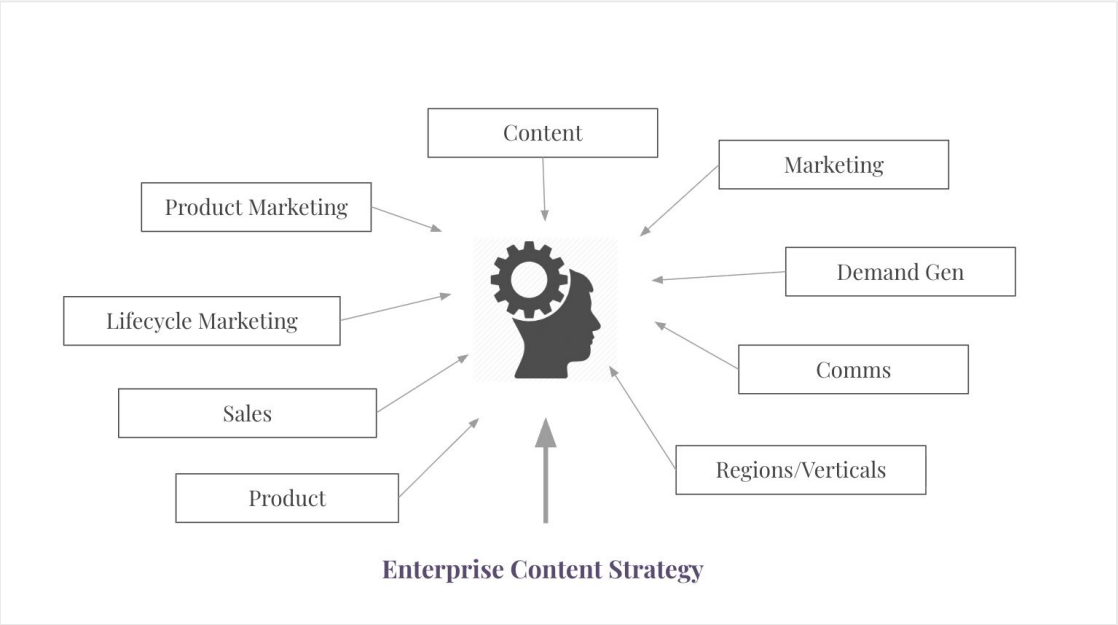


Connecting it all: An enterprise view

How can we ensure a consistent brand positioning, narrative, and story across all departments, functions, and Lines of Business (LoB), given the ubiquitous nature of content?

This demands an **"Enterprise content strategy"**—the highest-level, overarching content plan:

- A holistic perspective of an organization's structure, processes, data, and systems, enabling comprehensive management and strategic decision-making
- Connects disparate business units, providing leaders with a complete organizational picture—and importantly, a unified narrative that crosses all content spaces for all audiences



Key takeaways

Tying it all together...

- **Content is everywhere:** It exists across all departments—from HR and Sales to Product and Executive Communications—building credibility and supporting recruitment.
- **The need for consistency:** Because content is ubiquitous, organizations must ensure a consistent brand narrative and story across every line of business.
- **Enterprise content strategy:** This is the highest-level overarching plan that captures and considers a holistic perspective of an organization's structure, system, and mission.
- **Unified narrative:** A strategic approach connects disparate units, providing a complete organizational picture and a unified narrative for all audiences (internal, external, primary, secondary and tertiary)

Applying this to your day-to-day

Considerations for cross-functional collaboration:

Client Partners

- Ensure every project engagement aligns with the client's overarching ‘enterprise view’ considerate of their organizational structure and their ‘why’.
- Fish for opportunities outside of Marketing & Communications function; leaning into the clear outcome everyone can rally around—consistent content across all audiences.

Strategists

- Take a holistic perspective of the organization's structure and systems when developing content plans.
- Map how specific content pieces contribute to a consistent brand positioning across various Lines of Business (LoB) and operationally, what solutions need to be in place (people, tools, processes to achieve a unified content plan

Content & Creative Teams

- Produce content that reflects the unified narrative for all audiences, whether internal, external, or tertiary.
- Acknowledge that content is ubiquitous; every asset should reinforce the core organizational story and build credibility.

Quiz time!

Details about how long, etc.

Click here.

Up next...

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Expert counsel, effective content